

MIT Citation Guide: Comprehensive Demonstration

This document serves as a practical demonstration of the `mit-citation-guide` skill, showcasing how to apply MIT's rigorous academic standards across various citation styles and complex use cases. MIT emphasizes the critical importance of proper citation to acknowledge sources, avoid plagiarism, and enable verification ¹.

1. Citing AI-Generated Content

As AI tools become integral to research, MIT has established clear guidelines for their attribution. The core principle is transparency: authors must disclose the use of AI tools and cite them appropriately ².

Elements to Record

When using tools like ChatGPT, it is essential to save specific metadata for replication ²:

- **Tool name and version:** e.g., ChatGPT using GPT-4o
- **Date and time of usage:** e.g., May 4, 2026, 14:30 EST
- **Exact prompt:** e.g., "Summarize the key differences between APA and MLA citation styles."
- **Response:** The generated text.
- **Follow-up queries:** Any subsequent prompts.
- **User:** The name of the person who queried the AI.

Examples Across Styles

Style	Example Citation for AI Content
APA	OpenAI. (2026). <i>ChatGPT</i> (May 4 version) [Large language model]. https://chat.openai.com/chat
MLA	"Summarize the key differences between APA and MLA citation styles" prompt. <i>ChatGPT</i> , May 4 version, OpenAI, 4 May 2026, chat.openai.com/chat .
Chicago	1. Text generated by ChatGPT, OpenAI, May 4, 2026, https://chat.openai.com/chat .

Note: IEEE currently recommends treating AI-generated content as "Unpublished" content or disclosing it in the acknowledgments section ².

2. Citing Technical Documents and Conceptual Frameworks

Internal reports, conceptual drafts, and technical frameworks require specific handling to ensure readers can locate the source, even if it is unpublished ¹.

Example: Internal Conceptual Framework (IEEE Style)

When citing an internal draft like the "Structured Distance Measurement Conceptual Framework," include the author, title, version, status, and date ¹.

- ¹ Manus AI, "Structured Distance Measurement: A Multi-Agent Framework for Mapping the Edges of What Is Considered Correct," Version 0.3, Conceptual Draft, May 2026.

Example: Technical Report (APA Style)

Manus AI. (2026). *Performance analysis of multi-agent systems in sandboxed environments* (Tech. Rep. No. 2026-05). Manus Research Division.

3. Citing Datasets

Citing data is crucial for giving credit to data producers and enabling reproducibility ³. A complete data citation typically includes the author, title, year, publisher/distributor, and a persistent identifier (like a DOI) ³.

Example: Complete Dataset Citation

Bachman, Jerald G., Lloyd D. Johnston, and Patrick M. O'Malley. Monitoring the Future: A Continuing Study of American Youth (12th-Grade Survey), 1998 [Computer file]. Conducted by University of Michigan, Survey Research Center. ICPSR02751-v1. Ann Arbor, MI: Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research [producer and distributor], 2006-05-15. <http://dx.doi.org/10.3886/ICPSR02751> ³.

4. Standard Academic Sources

MIT does not mandate a single citation style but recommends consistency within a chosen style, often dictated by the specific discipline ¹.

Journal Article Examples

Style	Example Citation
APA	Hosseini, M., Rasmussen, L. M., & Resnik, D. B. (2023). Using AI to write scholarly publications. <i>Accountability in Research</i> , 1–9. https://doi.org/10.1080/08989621.2023.2168535
MLA	Hosseini, Mohammad, et al. "Using AI to Write Scholarly Publications." <i>Accountability in Research</i> , 2023, pp. 1–9, https://doi.org/10.1080/08989621.2023.2168535 .
IEEE	² M. Hosseini, L. M. Rasmussen, and D. B. Resnik, "Using AI to write scholarly publications," <i>Accountability in Research</i> , pp. 1–9, 2023.

References

- [1] MIT Libraries: Citation style guides
- [2] MIT Libraries: Citing AI tools
- [3] MIT Libraries: Cite data